



SYNAPSE

Complete User Guide

Centralized Student Portal & Academic Management System

A multi-tenant SaaS platform that lets independent schools manage students, teachers, classes, subjects, grades, attendance, exams, requests, documents, timetables, announcements and billing — each in its own fully isolated workspace.

Product

SYNAPSE (School Management SaaS)

Audience

Super Admins, School Administrators, Teachers, Students

Document version

1.0

Generated

August 2026

NOTE

This guide documents the SYNAPSE web application. The demo accounts listed in this guide are for development/demonstration purposes only and must never be used in production.

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Introduction

About SYNAPSE

SYNAPSE is a web-based School Management platform. It replaces scattered paper records and spreadsheets with one secure system where every school runs its academic and administrative operations. Schools register independently on the platform, and each school's data remains completely private and isolated from every other school.

The platform is organised around four roles, each with its own dashboard, navigation and permissions. Everything a user sees is limited to what their role and their school allow — enforced by the backend, never only by the interface.

Key concepts

- **Tenant (School):** an independent school on the platform. Each tenant has its own students, teachers, classes, subjects, academic years, semesters, grades, attendance, exams, requests, documents, announcements and billing.
- **Isolation:** a school can only ever see and manage its own data. Even manually changing URLs, IDs or request bodies cannot cross the boundary.
- **Academic year:** the school year (for example 2026/2027). One year is current at a time.
- **Semester:** a grading period within a year (for example Semester 1, Semester 2). Grades can be recorded per semester.
- **Teaching assignment:** the link between a teacher, a subject, a class and a year. It is the single source of truth for what a teacher may access.
- **Subscription plan:** a configurable plan (Starter, Professional, Enterprise) with pricing and limits on students, teachers and classes, plus feature flags.

Roles at a glance

Super Admin	Platform operator	Manages all schools, plans, subscriptions and payments on...
Administrator	School admin	Runs one school: structure, users, grades, attendance, exams,...
Teacher	Teaching staff	Views their assigned classes and subjects, enters grades, takes...
Student	Learner	Views their own grades, report card, timetable, attendance,...

Getting started

Accessing SYNAPSE

Open the SYNAPSE address in a web browser. The public landing page introduces the product. From there you can sign in, or register a new school. New schools are created through the onboarding flow, which sets up the school, its administrator account and a free trial.

Demo accounts

For local development the platform ships with demo data. Every demo password is password123.

superadmin@synapse.test	Super Admin	Platform (no school)
admin@synapse.test	Administrator	AICS Cameroon
teacher@synapse.test	Teacher	AICS Cameroon
sarah@synapse.test	Teacher	AICS Cameroon
felix@synapse.test	Teacher	AICS Cameroon
student@synapse.test	Student	AICS Cameroon
mary@synapse.test	Student	AICS Cameroon
peter@synapse.test	Student	AICS Cameroon
admin.saintalbert@synapse.test	Administrator	Saint Albert (trial)
teacher.saintalbert@synapse.test	Teacher	Saint Albert (trial)
student.saintalbert@synapse.test	Student	Saint Albert (trial)
admin.demo@synapse.test	Administrator	Demo Intl (expired)

Signing in and out

1. Open the sign-in page

Use the “Sign in” button on the landing page.

2. Enter your credentials

Type the email address and password issued by your school or platform administrator.

3. Arrive at your dashboard

SYNAPSE recognises your role and opens the matching dashboard (Super Admin, Administrator, Teacher or Student).

To sign out, open the avatar menu in the top-right corner and choose “Sign out”. The notification bell sits next to the avatar.

Notifications

The bell icon shows a red count of unread notifications. Open it to see recent activity (request updates, document ready, announcements, and so on). Click a notification to mark it read, or use “Mark all read”.

Subscription banners

School users may see a banner at the top of their workspace. It communicates the school's plan state clearly:

- Trial: "You're on a free trial — X days remaining."
- Expired: "Your subscription has expired. Please renew your plan to continue using SYNAPSE."
- Limit reached: "You have reached the students limit of your current plan."

IMPORTANT

Subscription status and plan limits are enforced by the backend. Hiding or changing the banner in the browser does not change the enforcement.

The Super Admin (platform)

The Super Admin manages the SYNAPSE platform itself — not a single school. Their sidebar offers Dashboard, Schools, Plans, Subscriptions and Payments.

Platform dashboard

The overview shows platform-wide key figures: total schools, total users, students, and active subscriptions, plus a chart of schools by plan, school statuses, and an estimated monthly recurring revenue (MRR) figure.

Managing schools

The Schools page lists every tenant with its slug, plan, status and user count.

1. Create a school

Use the “Create school” form (name, slug, and optional contact details). This is also where a school can be provisioned manually instead of via onboarding.

2. Open a school

Click a school name to view its details: contact information, plan, subscription status, timezone and its users.

3. Change status

From the detail page, use Activate, Trial, Suspend or Expire. Suspending or expiring a school blocks its academic operations but never deletes its data — the school can be restored later.

Subscription plans

Plans are fully configurable and never hard-coded. Each plan has a name, slug, price, billing interval, currency, student/teacher/class limits, and feature flags such as report cards, document management, notifications and custom branding. Use the Plans page to create or edit plans.

Subscriptions and payments

The Subscriptions page shows every subscription across the platform (school, plan, status, dates and amount). The Payments page lists payment records with provider, amount, status and reference. Development/mock payments are clearly flagged “sandbox”.

PAYMENTS

The platform ships with a payment abstraction (Mock, MTN Mobile Money, Orange Money, Card). Only the mock provider is active in development; live providers refuse to charge until real credentials are configured — the system never fabricates successful production payments.

The School Administrator

The Administrator runs a single school. Their workspace gives access to everything about that school — and nothing else.

Admin dashboard

The dashboard shows the school's counts (students, teachers, classes, subjects), quick actions to common tasks, the current academic year, and a small overview chart.

Academic structure

The Academic Structure page organises the school's setup into tabs:

- Academic years: create years (for example 2026/2027) and set the current one.
- Semesters: split the current year into grading periods and set the active semester.
- Classes: create class levels (for example Level 3A, Form 2).
- Subjects: create subjects with optional codes (for example ENG, MAT).
- Teaching assignments: assign each teacher to a subject + class. This is what grants teachers access.
- Grading: define weighted grade components (school-wide defaults or per subject).

Students and teachers

Use the Students and Teachers pages to register accounts. Each new student is enrolled in a class; each new teacher gets a staff number. The list below the form shows everyone in the school. If the school's plan has a limit and it is reached, registration is blocked with an upgrade message.

Bulk import

The Import page speeds up onboarding. Download a CSV template, fill it in, upload it and preview the rows, then import. The result screen reports how many records were created and which rows failed and why.

Timetable

Pick a class to see its weekly timetable as a grid (days as columns, time slots as rows). Click an empty cell to add a lesson, click a subject chip to edit it, or delete a slot. Each subject has a consistent colour so the schedule is easy to scan.

Attendance

Choose a class and a date to open the roll call. Mark each student Present, Absent, Late or Excused using the segmented control, or "Mark all present", then Save. The summary strip counts each status.

Exams and results

Schedule exam sessions (subject, class, semester, date, time and room) and view them grouped by date. The "Result compilation" panel ranks students by term average for any class + subject (optionally a semester).

Requests

Students submit document requests (for example a Certificate of Enrollment). As administrator you review and approve them. The request moves through Submitted !' Under Review !' Approved !' Ready. When approved

you can “Generate document”, which marks it Ready and makes it downloadable by the student. You can also reject a request.

Announcements

Publish announcements to your school. Choose an audience: Everyone, Students or Teachers. The announcement is delivered to that audience and appears in their notification bell.

Billing

The billing page shows the current plan, subscription status and renewal date, usage versus the plan limits (students, teachers, classes), payment history, and the available plans. Upgrade to change plan, or renew when expired. In development, payments use the sandbox mock provider.

Settings and branding

Configure how your school appears and behaves:

- Logo: upload, change or remove your school logo (PNG, JPG or SVG). It appears in the sidebar and on the report card.
- School name and brand colour: customise the school's identity across the portal.
- Custom branding toggle, grading scale, semester structure and timezone.

The Teacher

Teachers see only the classes and subjects the administrator assigned to them. Their sidebar offers Dashboard, My Assignments, Grade Entry, Attendance, Exams and Announcements.

Teacher dashboard

The dashboard shows the number of assignments, students and classes, followed by assignment cards. Each card links to the class roster and to grade entry.

My assignments

Lists every class + subject the teacher is allowed to teach, with the number of enrolled students. If a teacher tries to open a class or subject outside these assignments, access is denied.

Grade entry

Open a class to enter grades. The gradebook lists enrolled students with a score input per component.

- If the school configured weighted components (for example Assignments 30%, Quizzes 20%, Midterm 20%, Exam 30%), the columns match those components and the average is computed as $\frac{\text{score} \times \text{weight}}{\sum \text{weight}}$.
- Otherwise the classic Test 1 / Test 2 / Exam columns are used and the average is the mean of entered scores (out of 20).
- If the school uses semesters, choose the semester before entering grades.

Enter scores, watch the live average, and press “Save grades”. Grades are always attributed to the entering teacher and only enrolled students can be scored.

Attendance

Choose one of your classes and a date, then take the roll call (Present / Absent / Late / Excused) and save it — the same interface the administrator uses.

Exams and rankings

The Exams page shows the exam sessions scheduled for the teacher’s own subjects. The “Class ranking” panel compiles a ranked list of students by average for one of the teacher’s assignments.

The Student

Students see only their own academic information. The sidebar offers Dashboard, My Grades, Report Card, Timetable, Requests, Documents, Attendance, Transcript, Exams and Announcements.

Student dashboard

An overview with the overall average, subject count, pending requests and announcements, plus a performance ring, recent grades, the weekly timetable and the latest announcements.

My grades

Shows the overall average and every subject with its Test 1 / Test 2 / Exam scores and average. If the school uses semesters, use the tabs to view a single semester or the full year.

Report card

A printable term report with the school's branding, the student's average, their class rank, and a subject table with remarks (Excellent / Good / Fair / Needs work) and a term-average footer. Use "Print" to save it as a PDF.

Timetable

The weekly schedule for the student's class, displayed as a colour-coded grid with today's column highlighted.

Attendance

The student's own attendance rate for the year, with counts of present, absent, late and excused days, plus a recent history list.

Transcript

A multi-year academic history: every year the student was enrolled, the class they were in, their per-year average and a cumulative average across all years.

Exams

The exam timetable for the student's class, grouped by date with time and room for each subject.

Requests

Submit a document request by choosing the request type (Certificate of Enrollment, Transcript Request, Recommendation Letter, Other) and a reason. Track its progress with the status stepper (Submitted !' Under Review !' Approved !' Ready) and download the document once it is Ready.

Documents

All documents issued to the student, with a download button. Documents only become available after the administration approves the request and generates the file.

Reference

Statuses and terminology

School status	active, trial, suspended or expired.
Subscription status	trial, active, past_due, cancelled, expired or suspended.
Request status	submitted !' under_review !' approved !' ready (or rejected).
Attendance status	present, absent, late or excused.
Tenant	A school on the platform.
Teaching assignment	Teacher + subject + class + academic year.
Semester	A grading period within an academic year.
Weighted component	A named, weighted part of a subject average (e.g. Exam 30%).
Matricule	A student's unique school identifier.
Staff number	A teacher's unique school identifier.

Grading and averages explained

Scores are expressed out of 20.

- Weighted mode: average = $(16 \times 30 + 15 \times 20 + 16 \times 20 + 17 \times 30) \div 100$.
- Classic mode: average = mean of the entered Test 1, Test 2 and Exam scores.
- The overall (report card) average is the mean of the subject averages.

Frequently asked questions

How do I add my school logo? — As administrator, open Settings !' Branding and use "Upload logo". At onboarding, the logo field is on the School Information step.

Can two schools use the same class name? — Yes. Names and matricules are unique within a school, not across the platform.

What happens when the plan limit is reached? — Creating more students/teachers is blocked and an upgrade message is shown. Upgrade from Billing.

Can a teacher see another teacher's grades? — No. Grade entry is restricted to the assigned teacher for that subject and class.

How do I print a report card? — Open Report Card and press Print.

Security and data isolation

- Every tenant-owned record carries a school identifier and every query is scoped to the authenticated user's school.
- Roles are enforced by the backend; the frontend is never treated as a security boundary.
- Students can only read their own data; teachers only their assignments; administrators only their school; the super admin manages the platform.

- Passwords are stored as hashes, never in plain text. Sandbox payments are flagged and never used to simulate production revenue.

